

POCKETS

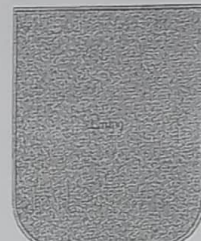
Types of pockets include: Patch pockets, inseam pockets, side hip and bound pockets

Lined patch pockets

Lining gives patch pockets a neat custom finish. Also, it adds opaqueness to loosely woven or sheer fabrics, which is a great benefit for working pockets that are made of such fabrics. Lining should not be expected to take the place of interfacing, however; it does not support the outer fabric well enough. Quite often you will need to both interface and line a patch pocket. The lining should be color-matched to the outer fabric, and can be of either the garment fabric itself (if it is not too heavy) or a traditional lining fabric. The lining may

extend to all edges or, if pocket has a facing, it may go only to the facing.

If a pocket is lined to all edges, use this trick to ensure that no lining shows at the edges. First, cut the lining slightly smaller than the pocket by trimming $\frac{1}{4}$ inch from all its cut edges. Center the lining on the pocket so edges correspond, and stitch on the seamline. When the pocket is turned, the lining will pull the finished edge slightly to the wrong side. Press, remembering that the objective is crisp, sharp edges with no lining visible on the right side.

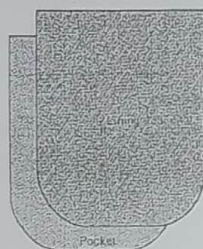


Patch pocket lined entirely to edge

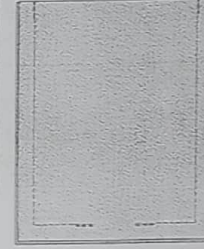


Patch pocket lined to edge of facing

Lining entire pocket



1. Cut pocket pieces out. For a **separately lined pocket**, cut lining exactly like pocket piece. For a **self-lined pocket**, cut pocket double size, with a fold at the top edge.



2. For a **separately lined pocket**, place right sides of pocket and lining together and pin along all edges. For a **self-lined pocket**, fold pocket in half, with right sides together, and pin the edges together. Stitch on seamline around raw edges, leaving small portion of bottom edge open. Press flat.



3. Trim and grade seam; taper corners. If pocket is rounded, notch out excess fabric so that when pocket is turned there is no excess fabric in seam allowances.



4. Turn pocket to right side, gently pressing it through the open portion in the seam at the bottom edge. Pull out all corners; roll seam to the edge so that it is not visible from the right side. Press. Slipstitch opening at bottom closed.

(Source: Reader's Digest: Complete Sewing Guide)

Patch Pocket Application

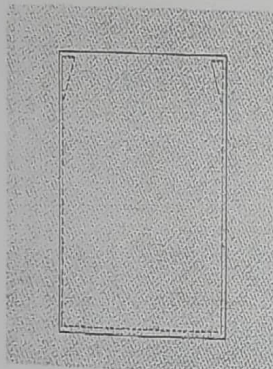
This type of pocket is simple, versatile and can be applied on most garments. It is however most ideal for shirts, blouses and backs of trousers and skirts.

Procedure for making patch pockets

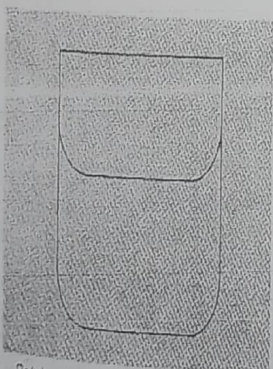
1. Baste the pocket in position on the garment.
2. The patch pocket may be secured to the garment by hand or machine.
3. Hands secure the pocket in place more firmly.
4. Remove thread basting and press.

General information

Patch pockets are essentially shaped pieces of fabric that are finished on all sides, then attached to the garment by hand or machine. They may be lined or unlined, and may also be decorated in any of several ways before being attached to the garment. If pockets are to be used in pairs, take care that the finished pockets are the same size and shape; a cardboard template cut to that size is helpful for guiding stitching and pressing. If a plaid, a stripe, or a print is to be matched, the pocket must be cut so this is possible; a striped or plaid pocket may be cut on the opposite grain from the garment or on the bias for added contrast.



Plain patch pocket, attached with topstitching



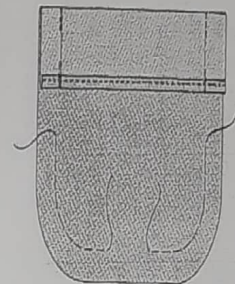
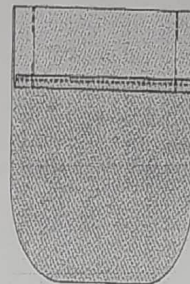
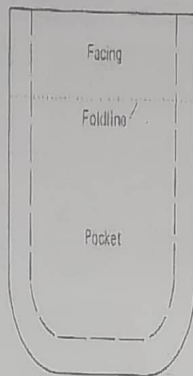
Patch pocket with flap, attached by hand

Unlined patch pockets

Unlined patch pockets are used on casual clothes, such as jeans, shirts, aprons, and the like. Their edges are finished off by turning the facing at

the top and the seam allowances at the sides and bottom to the wrong side. If lower corners of pocket are rounded, extra fullness in the seam

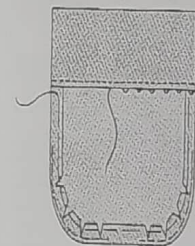
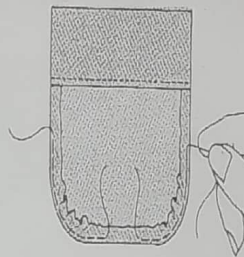
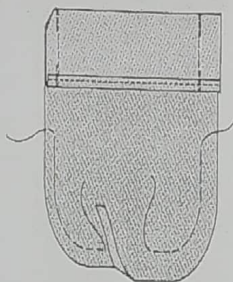
allowance must be notched out so that there is no overlapping of fabric to cause bulk. If the lower corners are square, they must be mitered.



Unlined patch pockets usually have a self-facing at the opening edge, which is turned to the inside during construction.

1. Turn under raw edge of pocket facing and edgestitch. Fold facing to the right side along foldline and stitch each side on seamline.

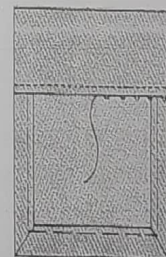
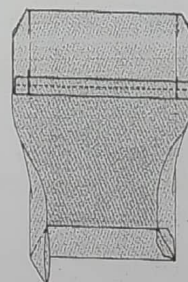
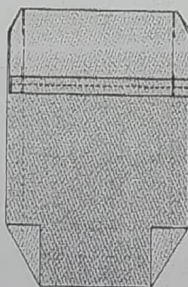
2. If pocket has rounded corners, easestitch at each corner a thread width into the seam allowance from the seamline.



3. Trim entire pocket seam allowance to $\frac{1}{4}$ " and cut diagonally across each corner at top. Turn facing to wrong side; pull corners out.

4. Press top edge. Pull easestitching at corners to draw in seam allowance and shape pocket curve. Notch out excess fabric.

5. Press pocket seam allowances and facing flat. Hand-baste around entire pocket edge and slipstitch facing to pocket.



To miter a square corner, first make a diagonal fold to the right side across the junction of the seamlines. Press to crease.

Open the fold and place the right sides of the seam allowances together. Stitch on the crease from raw edge to corner. Trim.

Turn corners and facing to wrong side and press entire pocket flat. Hand-baste around all edges and slipstitch facing to pocket.

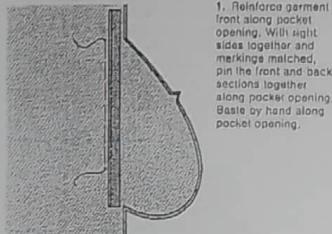
[Source: Reader's Digest: Complete Sewing Guide]

Seam Applications

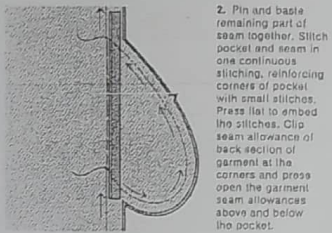
Inseam Pocket

This type of pocket is most ideal for dresses and skirts.

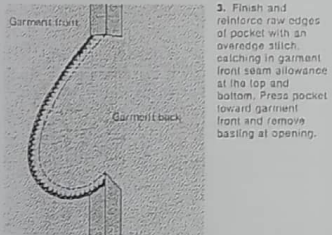
All-in-one in-seam pocket



1. Reinforce garment front along pocket opening. With right sides together and markings matched, pin the front and back sections together along pocket opening. Baste by hand along pocket opening.

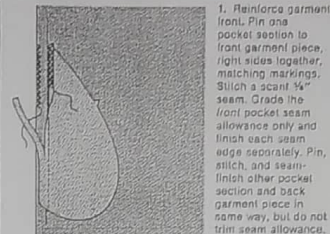


2. Pin and baste remaining part of seam together. Stitch pocket and seam in one continuous stitching, reinforcing corners of pocket with small stitches. Press flat to embed the stitches. Clip seam allowance of back section of garment at the corners and press open the garment seam allowances above and below the pocket.

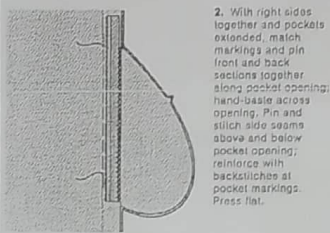


3. Finish and reinforce raw edges of pocket with an overedge stitch, catching in garment front seam allowance at the top and bottom. Press pocket toward garment front and remove basting at opening.

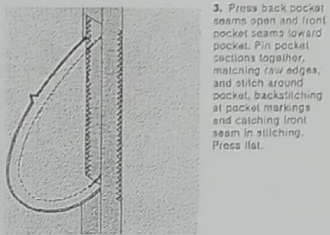
Separate in-seam pocket



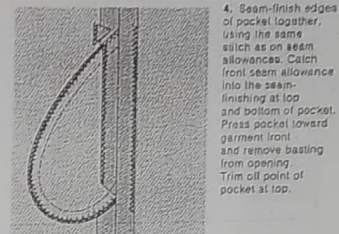
1. Reinforce garment front. Pin one pocket section to front garment piece, right sides together, matching markings. Stitch a scant $\frac{1}{4}$ " seam. Grade the front pocket seam allowance only and finish each seam edge separately. Pin, stitch, and seam-finish other pocket section and back garment piece in same way, but do not trim seam allowance.



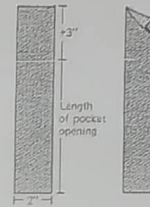
2. With right sides together and pockets extended, match markings and pin front and back sections together along pocket opening. Hand-baste across opening. Pin and stitch side seams above and below pocket opening; reinforce with backstitches at pocket markings. Press flat.



3. Press back pocket seams open and front pocket seams toward pocket. Pin pocket sections together, matching raw edges, and stitch around pocket, backstitching at pocket markings and catching front seam in stitching. Press flat.



4. Seam-finish edges of pocket together, using the same stitch as on seam allowances. Catch front seam allowance into the seam, finishing at top and bottom of pocket. Press pocket toward garment front and remove basting from opening. Trim off point of pocket at top.



Adding a facing to the opening edge of the pocket will keep any of the pocket fabric from showing if pocket gape open.
1. Cut two strips of garment fabric on the straight grain, each measuring 2" wide by the length of the pocket opening plus 2". Turn under and press $\frac{1}{4}$ " to the wrong side on one long edge of each facing strip.



2. Apply facing to pocket before sewing pocket into garment. Place wrong side of each facing on the right side of each pocket piece, with the raw edges even at opening. Edgestitch along pressed-under edge. Then stitch other long edge of pocket facing to pocket $\frac{1}{4}$ " from raw edge. Trim away excess facing fabric at top and bottom of pocket.

(Source: Reader's Digest: Complete Sewing Guide)

Procedure for making inseam pockets

- 1)
 - Stitch each pocket section to its corresponding garment facing with RS together.
 - Press each seam towards pocket.
- 2)
 - Pin the garment sections with RS together, dots matching and pockets aligned with each other.
 - Stitch along the seam line, pivoting at the inner corner dot.
 - Stitch around the pocket, pivot again at the upper corner dot and continue stitching the side seam.
 - Baste along the fold line between the dots.
- 3)
 - Turn the pocket toward the garment front along the basted fold line.

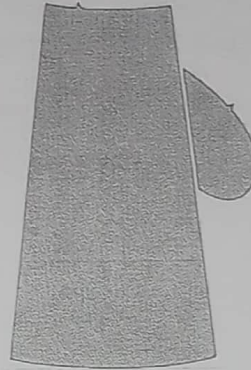
- Press the back seam allowance above and below the facing extension.
- Press the garment seams open and press pocket flat.
- Remove the basting after the garment has been completed.

In-seam pockets

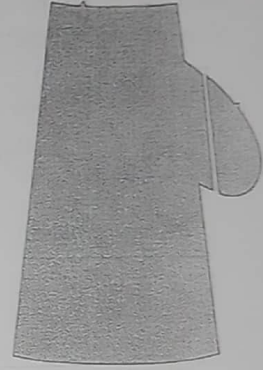
Although all finished in-seam pockets look the same from the right side of the garment, they may be constructed in three different ways, depending on how the pattern is designed. In the all-in-one in-seam pocket, the pocket is part of the garment, so the two are cut as one and there is no seam at the opening of the pocket. The sep-



All-in-one in-seam pocket

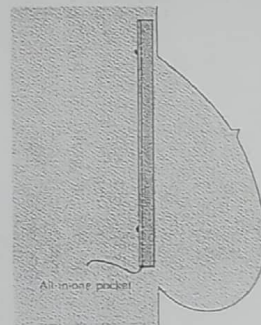


Separate in-seam pocket

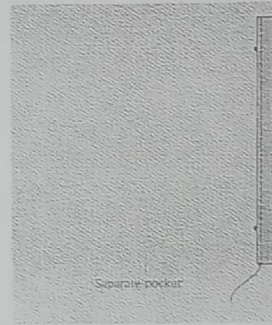


Extension in-seam pocket

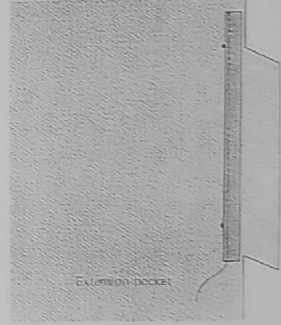
Reinforcing in-seam pockets



All-in-one pocket



Separate pocket



Extension pocket

arate in-seam pocket is made up of separate pocket and garment pieces that are joined in the seamline to create the pocket. The extension in-seam pocket is made up of a separate pocket piece and a garment piece that has a small projection designed to extend into the pocket opening.

Because inside pockets generally receive a great deal of wear, the seam into which they are set must be reinforced with a stay to prevent stretching. Use a sturdy lining fabric for the pocket to reduce bulk.

Seamline of front garment section must be reinforced before any in-seam pocket is sewed in, regardless of type. Cut a length of woven seam tape equal to the pocket opening plus 2".

Position tape on the wrong side of the pocket seamline, centering it next to the marks for the pocket opening. (Drawings show position for each pocket type.) One edge should be

aligned with seamline; the width of the tape should be on the seam allowance or extension of garment. Baste, then stitch tape in place $\frac{1}{4}$ " from edge nearest seamline.

(Source: Reader's Digest: Complete Sewing Guide)

Side/Front Hip Pocket

This type of pocket is most ideal for skirts, shorts and trousers and is best made on firm fabric.

Procedure for making the pocket

- 1) Stitch tacks or darts in skirt or pants front.
 - Press darts toward CF and press tucks towards side seam.
 - Stitch darts in pocket lining stay and press toward CF
- 2) To prevent the slanted pocket edge from stretching, stay the seam line with binding.

- 3) Stitch the pocket lining stay to the shaped upper side of the garment front. Trim the seam without cutting the seam binding.
- 4) Turn the pocket lining stay to the inside and press. Top stitch 3 to 6 mm (1/8" to 1/4") from the finished edge.
- 5) Stitch the side front section to the pocket lining. Stay along the outer curved edge of the side front, following marked seam lines. Keep garment free of stitching.
- 6) Turn the pocket section down next to the WS of the garment front. Match seam lines and CF lines of pocket lining, stay and garment. Baste along CF line, waistline and side seam.
- 7) Finish garment construction. The pocket lining stay will be caught in the stitching of the zipper construction, or if the garment has no CF zipper in the front seam, the edges of the pocket will be caught in the side seam.

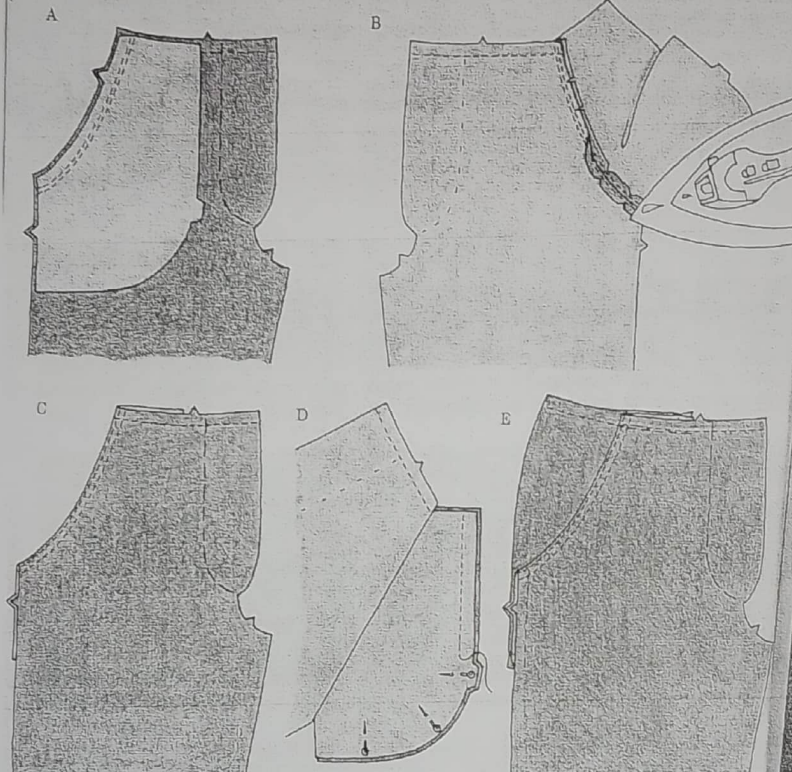
Front Hip Pockets

Many pants and skirts feature partially hidden hipline pockets. While the opening edge of the pocket may be straight or curved, the sewing method is the same for either shape.

If your fashion fabric is heavy or bulky, cut the pocket facing from lightweight lining fabric in a matching color. First, staystitch the waistline edges of the front section and the side front pocket section, as well as the pocket opening edges of the front and pocket facing sections, to keep them from stretching.

Stitching: With right sides together and notches and markings matching, pin the pocket facing to the garment front along the opening edge; stitch (A). Trim and clip this seam; then press the seam open (B). Turn the pocket facing to the inside and press again. On the outside, edgestitch close to the seam; you may also topstitch $\frac{1}{4}$ "

(6 mm) away if desired (C). With right sides together, pin the side front pocket piece to the pocket facing along the double-notched edge, matching raw edges, notches and markings. Be careful not to catch the garment front when you pin. Stitch the double-notched edges together (D). On the outside, lap the garment front over the side front pocket; machine-baste them together at the side hip and waistline edges as shown (E).



(Source: Simplicity Sewing Book)

Set-In Pocket Applications

These are constructed much like a large buttonhole.

- The pocket is set into the garment through a narrow slash that hangs inside. Therefore there is little chance of correcting stitching errors.
- Precision marking, stitching, cutting and pressing are particularly crucial to quality construction.
- The bound and welt pocket are examples of set-in pockets.
- They are often found on tailored garments and men's wear.

- The piping and welt are constructed from garment or contrasting fabric and inside pocket sections are constructed from lining to reduce bulk.

Bound Pockets

The bound pocket closely resembles an oversized bound buttonhole.

Preparation Procedure

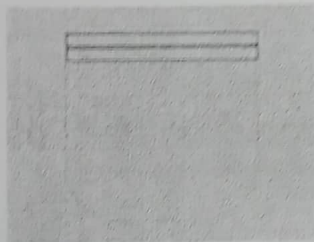
- 1) For each pocket, cut two piping strips 3.2 cm (1 1/4") wide and 2.5 cm (1") longer than the finished pocket length. The strips may be cut on the lengthwise or bias grain lines.
 - 2) Fold each strip in half lengthwise with WS together press and baste 4.5 mm from fold.
 - 3) From the RS of garment position each piping strip over the pocket markings, machine stitching lines precisely.
- The folded edges will face outward and the strip ends will extend 1.3 cm (1/2") beyond the pocket end markings. Baste securely. The set-in pocket lining application for bound, welt and flap pockets is the same.

Slashed pockets

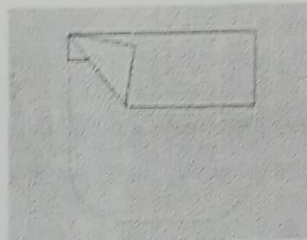
There are three types of slashed pockets, which differ only in the way the pocket opening is finished. When the pocket acts as a finish, the result is a bound pocket, which looks like a large bound buttonhole. A second method

is with a flap, which covers the pocket after insertion into the upper edge of the slash. Flaps are usually, but not necessarily, rectangular. The third finish, a welt, is a rectangular piece, cut separately or as a part of the

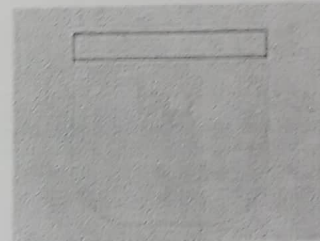
pocket, that fits over the pocket opening and is sewed into the lower edge of the slash. (A variation is a double welt—one at each edge of the slash.) The three finishes may be used together in almost any combination.



Bound pocket



Pocket with flap on top edge

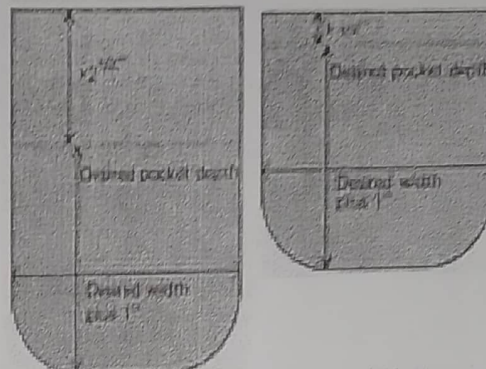


Single welt pocket

Bound pockets

Bound pockets are those in which the pocket itself is used to finish off, or bind, the edges of the slash in the garment. From the right side of the garment, the pocket looks like a large bound buttonhole. Although lining fabric is generally recommended for inside pockets, in this pocket type the pocket fabric will show on the outside, so the garment fabric is preferable for the purpose.

When the pocket is completed, arrowhead tacks may be worked at each end for a tailored look (see Hand stitches). Check any pattern you plan to use to be sure that the pocket pieces meet the specifications below. If they do not, alter them to conform.

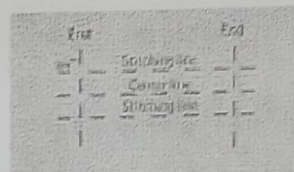


Notes for bound pocket: This pocket type requires two pocket sections. The first should measure desired pocket depth plus $2\frac{1}{2}$ ". The second, pocket depth plus $\frac{1}{2}$ ". Cutting length of both desired width plus 1" for side seams.

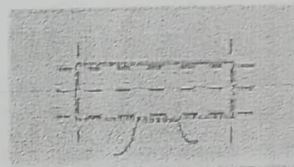
Pointers for slashed pockets

Slashed pockets are thought to be the most difficult of the inside pockets to construct. Actually, they are only a matter of precise marking and exact stitching, combined with very careful cutting. Construction is very much like that of a bound buttonhole, although the finished result is much larger. The pocket back and front are not joined until they have been attached to the opening edge, which is the slash in the garment. The seams of the pocket itself are then formed.

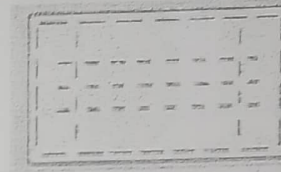
Carefully thread-trace the opening for the pocket on the right side of the garment, using a very small hand stitch. Be sure markings are exactly on grain (unless the pockets are diagonally placed) and that center and stitching lines are exactly parallel. All permanent machine stitching should be done with a very short stitch. Press carefully at each step of construction; a final pressing by itself is not sufficient to set sharp edges.



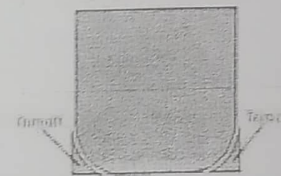
Draw across ends to mark width of opening, then through center line and set parallel stitching lines to mark depth of opening; extend marks about $\frac{1}{4}$ " beyond the actual ends. Be sure lines are straight and parallel.



Slash rectangle precisely for any type of slashed pocket. Begin stitching at center of one side and pivot at corners. Take same number of stitches across each end; overlap stitches at starting point to secure.



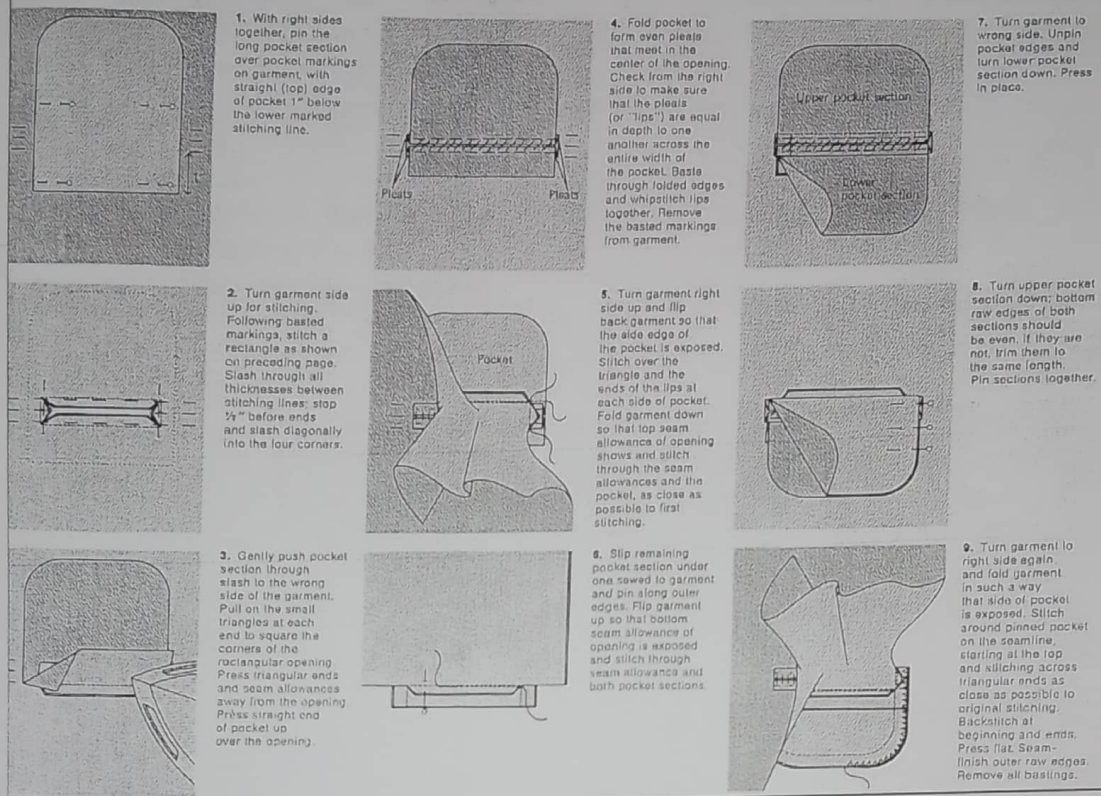
If garment fabric is lightweight or loosely woven, add a stay of lightweight interfacing for stability and crispness. Cut it about 4" long and 2" wider than opening; center it behind pocket opening and trace in place.



Curve pocket corners if they are square on the pattern, to prevent any fat buildup in the pocket from repeated wearings and washings. Instead of pivoting when stitching the pocket, simply round the corners off.

(Source: Reader's Digest: Complete Sewing Guide)

Constructing bound pockets



[Source: Reader's Digest: Complete Sewing Guide]

Set-in Pocket Lining

Application Procedure

The inside pocket lining sections are applied to both the bound and welt pockets with the same construction techniques.

- 1) Position the pocket lining over the welt on flap with the longer pocket portion to the top of the garment. Match construction lines precisely and baste using short running stitches exactly on seam lines.
- 2) Stitch on the upper and lower stitching lines using very short reinforcement stitches and secure ends.
- 3) Carefully slash between the two stitching lines to within 1.3 cm ($\frac{1}{2}$ ") of each end. Clip diagonally to each diagonally.
- 4) Turn pocket lining to the inside of the garment. Turn welt upwards gently pull small triangles to inside and each end to square the corners.

- 5) Press the triangles and seam allowances away from the opening. Stitch pocked edges together. Catch the triangle ends in the stitching. Backstitch across triangles several times to secure.
 - Stitch the pocket again 1 cm (3/8") from edge to strengthen.
- 6) To finish
 - a) Slip stitch the welt end is place invisibly to hold the welt upright. Remove basting and press.
 - b) Press the flap downward.